

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

1 · Framework		Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map	
Method	Uses	Region	Organ
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)	L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Auscult./Olfact.	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)	Forehead	Heart
Inquiry	Verbal questioning	Nose	Spleen
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse	R cheek (patient's)	Lung
		Chin	Kidney

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

Quick Recall: Face-forward pictures mirror this — patient's left is on YOUR right.

Deranged Shen (shén luàn)		3 · Five Colors of Face	
Deranged Shen	Presentation	Color	Indication
Fǎn zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation	Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC	Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)
Bái hé bìng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking	Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/ damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)
Diǎn (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry	Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities	Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.

Secretions: Color Rule	
Finding	Meaning
Clear/white	Deficiency/cold
Turbid/yellow	Excess/heat

2 · Shen (Vitality) — Having vs. Loss vs. False Shen			
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady

Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.

4 · Appearance, Body Shape & Movement		5 · Eyes: Five Wheels		
Body Shape		Wheel	Structure	Organ
Finding	Pattern	Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Overweight + depression	Qi deficiency + excess phlegm-damp	Qi	Sclera	Lung
Thin person, dry skin	Blood insufficiency	Wind	Iris	Liver
Great weight loss, long illness	Exhaustion of essential Qi	Water	Pupil	Kidney
Large barrel chest/epigastrium	Full (excess) lung/stomach condition	Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/ Stomach
Large, overweight thighs	Spleen not transforming/transporting	Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.		
Thin body overall	Yin deficiency			
Overweight body overall	Yang deficiency with phlegm			

Movement & Posture		Eye Color	
Finding	Pattern	Color	Pattern
Active movement	Yang syndrome	Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)	Damp-heat, heat predominant
Passive manner	Yin syndrome	Dull, dusky yellow	Damp-heat, damp predominant
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)	Dull, dark yellow	Cold-damp
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome	Deep yellow + bloodshot	Toxic heat in the blood level
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)	Dull, dark yellow-brown	Blood stasis (dark rings, purple tongue)
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia / wind-stroke	Red (inner/outer canthus)	Heart fire (or SI, if outer canthus)
Quick movement + heat	Excess Yang	Red, entire eye + headache	Rising Liver fire
Slow movement + cold	Deficiency Yin	Red sclera, sore throat, cough	Exterior wind-heat affecting Lung

Finding	Pattern	Color	Pattern
Small, restless fidgeting	Empty (deficiency) heat	Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold	Exterior invasion of wind-heat
Tremors, convulsions	Wind (involuntary movement)		
Paralysis	Internal wind		
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or wind		

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yin deficiency.

Eye Color (cont.)		Eye Shape/Move (cont.)	
Color	Pattern	Presentation	Pattern
Blue-green	Liver wind (tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)	Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat	Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction
		Both eyes deviate up/high fever/coma	Extreme heat generating wind
Bluish	Internal cold, or Kidney Yin deficiency	Deviation after trauma	Blood stasis
Dark sclera (crab-eye black)	Accumulated heat	Congenital deviation	Essence deficiency (Kidney)
Dark eye sockets, sunken	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Frequent spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale, steady pulse	Blood deficiency
White rings around iris	Turbid phlegm		
Cloudy white iris	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Eyelids heavy/tired feeling	Spleen Qi deficiency
Pale white vessels in canthus	Blood or Yang deficiency	Occasional spasm + red/itchy + fever/chills	Exterior invasion (wind-heat)
		Droopy eyelids (ptosis)	Qi sinking, or wind attacking channels

Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.

Eye Shape & Movement

Presentation	Pattern
Bulging/protruding + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang rising w/ heat+damp
Protruding + neck swelling, tinnitus, 5-center heat	Liver Yin def. w/ relative Yang excess
Sunken + slight cough, weak voice	Lung deficiency
Sunken + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness	Spleen deficiency
Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse	Yin/Yang collapse (severe)
Swollen, sudden onset, no color change	Fluid malfunction (Spleen def. w/ damp)
Bags under the eyes	Spleen & Kidney deficiency
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling	Wind attacking channels

6 · Nose

Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).

Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
White tip	Blood deficiency
Red tip	Heat
Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
Red bridge	Liver fire

Finding	Pattern
Dry and black	Toxic heat
Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
Swollen nose	Excess condition
Sunken nose	Deficiency condition
Nasal polyps	Stagnated heat in Yangming channel

Quick Recall: Normal nose = slightly moist and shiny.

Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 · Ears8 · Teeth

Kidney opens to ear. Kidney — teeth are the "surplus of bone."

Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Swelling/pain, middle ear	Heat in the Shaoyang	White, moist, bright/clean	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry/withered/black auricle, chronic illness	Kidney essence exhausted	Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Purulent discharge ("Tin Er")	Damp-heat Liver/GB	Yellowing, gradual w/ age	Normal aging
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency	Sudden dull yellow (soybean)	Kidney deficiency
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution	Gray and black (black bean)	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Small earlobes	Poor constitution	Dry, black, gray	Kidney Yin deficiency
Shiny, moist earlobes	Good prognosis	Tartar, grimy yellow	Stomach turbidity
Dry, withered earlobes	Poor prognosis / Kidney Qi exhaustion	Burnt and dry	Kidney & Stomach Yin deficiency

Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Yellow/white pus discharge	Kidney Yin def. w/ fire, or Liver/GB damp-heat	Delayed baby/adult teeth	Essence and Jing deficiency
Ear color: white	Sudden wind-cold invasion	Deviated growth / missing	Insufficient Yangming Qi
Ear color: green/black	Pain	Loss of teeth in adult, receding gums	Fire flaring up from Kidney Yin def.
Ear color: black	Kidney failure		
Ear color: red	Excess heat (possibly damp-heat)		
Ear color: yellow	Damp accumulation		

Tinnitus	Organ
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney

Gums (Spleen/Stomach)		Throat & Tonsils (Stomach+Lung)	
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Moist, deep red (normal)	Normal	Deep red throat/pharynx	Heat
Deep red + swelling	Excess heat / Stomach fire	Pale red throat	Empty (deficiency) heat
Pale	Blood deficiency	Acute pain+redness+swelling	Wind invasion (exterior)
Atrophied	Kidney deficiency	Chronic redness/swelling	Interior Stomach heat
Blue line between teeth/gums	Mercury poisoning	Chronic sore/dry, NOT swollen/red	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat
Swollen, ulcerated, bleeding	Stomach fire pushing blood out	Erosion, redness, swelling, yellowish-red	Heat in Stomach/Intestines
Lips & Mouth (Spleen)		Chronic erosion, comes and goes	Empty (deficiency) heat
		Chronic erosion, hard raised ulcers	Blood stasis with phlegm-heat
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Pale lips	Blood deficiency	Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/phlegm retention, Qi deficiency bg.
Blue-purplish lips	Retention of cold OR blood stagnation	Chronically red/swollen tonsils	Heat or toxic heat, Stomach/LI
Bright red lips	Heat toxins	Acutely red/swollen tonsils	Wind-heat invasion w/ toxicity
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat	Acute red/swollen with exudate	Heat toxins, Stomach/LI (vs. cold)
Dry, red lips	Heat damaging fluids		
Purple lips	Blood stasis (stabbing pain)		
Deviated mouth	Wind		
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency pattern		
Finding	Pattern		
Mouth remains open + fever/thirst/canker sores	Excess heat		
Breathing through open mouth	Empty/deficiency pattern		
Open mouth + SOB + frothy sputum	Lung deficiency w/ phlegm stagnation		
Sudden attack, drooling, LOC	Wind		

9 • Hair		Skin	
Blood + Kidney Essence. Women ruled by Blood, men by Qi.		Finding	Pattern
Finding	Pattern	Lustrous, harmonious (normal)	Normal
		Red	Heat
		Yellow, orangish	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
		Yellow, dusky	Damp-heat, more damp than heat
		Too moist	Lung not controlling fluids
		Dry	Blood/fluid deficiency
		Dark, with scales	Blood stasis
		Itching	Wind
Nails		Finding	Pattern
		Pitting edema (upper→down)	Yang edema, Spleen/Kidney Yang def.
		Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation or dampness
		Edema from feet up, worse below	Yin edema
Finding	Pattern	Skin Lesions	
		Lesion	Description
		Papule	Raised, red, seed-sized; fades w/ pressure
		Macule	Flat red patch; does NOT fade w/ pressure
		Blister	Fluid-filled, thick or thin walls
		Nodule	Palpable, solid, round
		Term	Cause
		Yong — Yang carbuncle	Internal accumulation of fire toxins
		Ju — Yin carbuncle	Insufficient Qi/Blood + Qi/Yin/cold stagnation
Finding	Pattern	Ding — boil/furuncle	Exogenous wind-fire toxins, surface heat
		Jie — furuncle	Stagnated Qi/Blood from damp-heat in skin
Finding	Pattern		

Finding	Pattern
Red thenar veins	Heat
Purple thenar veins	Blood stasis

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic

Applies to nasal discharge, sputum, stool, vaginal discharge alike.

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess.

11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis

Age <3. Left index finger=boys, right index finger=girls.

Gate Reached	Severity	Vein Color	Indication
Wind Gate only	Mild illness / exterior pathogen	Bright red	Heat
Qi Gate	Interior condition, stronger illness	Purple	Stronger heat, creating stasis
Life Gate	Severe illness	Green or dark blue	Wind
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening		

12 · Constitutional Types (Flagged)

Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao’s recorded lecture says **"Nothing on the body constitutions"** will be tested. Prof. Schrier’s own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it. Confirm with him which governs the quiz.

Weak vs. Strong Constitution (Ling Shu 54)

Marker	Weak	Strong
Eyes/nose/ears/mouth	Close together	Well-proportioned
Space between eyebrows	Small	Broad forehead/forehead
Nose	Narrow, flared	Straight, well-formed
Philtrum	Short	Long
Cheeks	Thin	Full, normal luster
Jaw	Flat, sunken, narrow	Strong, even, smooth
Ears	Small, short lobes	Long, long lobes
Muscles/skin	Flabby, loose	Firm

Cause of Weak Constitution	Five-Element Body Types (Ling Shu 64)		
Parents’ general health	Element	Physical	Personality
Health at time of conception	Wood	Green complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, tall, sinewy	Superior talent, hardworking, survives sickness
Mother’s health during pregnancy	Fire	Red complexion, small head/hands/feet, curly/little hair, walks fast+sways	Frivolous w/ wealth, passionate, impulsive, curious
Parental age/pregnancy events (stress, trauma, drugs/alcohol/smoking)	Earth	Yellow complexion, round face, big head, wide jaws, large abdomen	Dignified, calm, unassertive, likes helping people
	Metal	Pale complexion, square face, flat abdomen, strong voice	Honest, upright, rational, leadership aptitude
	Water	Dark complexion, big head, wrinkles, round body, swaying gait	Laid-back, unafraid, tendency to deceive, always moving

Heads Up — Constitution is not fixed: Pre-Heavenly (Jing) essence is the basis; Post-Heavenly Qi (diet, herbs, acupuncture, yang sheng) can improve it.

Quick Recall: Wood=tall/hardworking. Fire=curly/impulsive. Earth=round/calm. Metal=square/honest. Water=dark/deceptive.